

Saber Khani

Contact Information

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Research Interests

Collective Behavior and Social Movements, Political Sociology, Global and Transnational Sociology, Computational Social Science, Quantitative Methods, Global Middle East and North Africa (MENA).

Education

Ph.D. in Sociology <i>Boston College</i>	Sep 2021 - July 2027 (exp) Boston, USA
M.Sc Sociology <i>Boston College</i>	Sep 2019 - May 2021 Boston, USA
B.S. Sociology <i>Tehran University</i>	June 2016 Tehran, Iran

Publications Peer-reviewed journal articles

* graduate student co-authors
Ferati, Jalal*, **Saber Khani**, and Akash Chopra*. 2026. "From Presence to Prominence: Institutional Pathways and Women's Appointments to Cabinets Across Regimes." *Perspectives on Politics*. Conditionally Accepted. [Flagship American Political Science Association (APSA) Journal; Clarivate ; 5-Yr Impact Factor: 5.6]

Vogelsang, Eric, Sara Moorman, Alan Mijares, Zackary Zanolletti, Reza Tayari Ash-tiani, and **Saber Khani**. 2025. "Older Adult Social Participation and Cognition: Illustrating Survey and Measurement Heterogeneity Across Studies." *Research on Aging*.

Khani, Saber and Sara Moorman. 2025. "Beyond the Classroom: How High School Extracurricular Activities Shape Cognitive Health in Later Life." *The Journals of Gerontology: Series B (Editor's Choice)*.

Moorman, Sara and **Saber Khani**. 2024. "High School Curriculum and Cognitive Function in the Eighth Decade of Life." *Alzheimer Disease & Associated Disorders* 38(3):235-240.

Khani, Saber and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. 2023. "Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)." *Comparative Political Studies* 57(10):1668-1702. [Flagship American Political Science Association (APSA) Journal; Clarivate Q1 Top 10%; 5-Yr Impact Factor: 6.0]

Manuscripts Under Review	Khani, Saber. “Drilling and Dissent: Oil, Corruption, and Contention - Evidence From a Dual-Level Analysis, 2005–2019.” <i>Social Problems</i> . Under review.
	Khani, Saber and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. “Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocratic Regimes.” <i>American Sociological Review</i> . Under review.
	Kadivar, Mohammad Ali and Saber Khani . “The Politics of War Commemoration in Iran.” <i>American Journal of Sociology</i> . Under review.
	Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, Saber Khani , Danial Vahabli, Vahid Abedini, and Samira Barzin. “The Contingency of Structures: Triggers and the Social Geography of Revolutionary Episodes in Iran 2018 - 2022.” <i>Social Forces</i> . Under review.
	Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, Saber Khani , Danial Vahabli. “Who Made the Iranian Revolution? Mobilization and Death, 1977–1979.” <i>American Political Science Review</i> . Under review.
Working Papers	Kadivar, Mohammad Ali, Saber Khani . “Uneven Incorporation: Ethnic Inequality Across Social Domains in Iran.” <i>The Journal of Development Studies</i> . Under review.
	Khani, Saber. “Smelling the Source: Oil Pollution, Sulfur Dioxide, and Targeted Protest in a Global Grid Cell Analysis, 2019–2024.” Manuscript ready for journal submission.
Original Datasets	Khani, Saber. “In the Shadow of Extraction: How Perceived Proximity to Oil Infrastructure Fuels Dissent.” Manuscript ready for journal submission.
	Saber Khani and Mohammad Ali Kadivar. 2023. “ Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds: State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization Evidence from Iran (2015-2019) .” <i>Harvard Dataverse</i> , V1.
	Mohammad Ali Kadivar and Saber Khani . “Islamic Republic Martyrs Dataset (IRMD) (1980-1988).” N = 214,000 ⁺ individuals.
	Saber Khani . “Petroprotest: Oil-Related Unarmed Protests Across 180 Countries (2005-2024).” N = 12,000 ⁺ events.
	<i>Survey</i> Saber Khani . “Iraq National Survey (Feb–May 2025).” N = 750 ⁺ respondents across all 18 governorates. A comprehensive survey examines Iraqi citizens’ protest participation since 2015, perceptions of oil sector corruption and governance, and attitudes toward environmental impacts and economic policies.
Other Writings	Saber Khani . “Basra City Survey (Mar–Apr 2025).” N = 500 participants from Basra city neighborhoods. This focused survey covers the same national topics while adding Basra-specific questions about proximity to oil infrastructure, local impacts of petroleum facilities on daily life, and comparative regional perspectives.
	Mohammad Ali Kadivar, Peyman Jafari, Mehdi Hoseini, and Saber Khani . 2021. “ Labor Organizing on the Rise Among Iranian Oil Workers .” <i>Middle East Report Online</i> .

Mohammad Ali Kadivar, **Saber Khani**, and Abolfazl Sotoudeh. 2019. “[Iran’s Protests Are Not Just About Gas Prices](#).” *Foreign Affairs*.

Fellowships and Awards	Young Scholars in Social Movements Mini-Conference (\$800) <i>University of Notre Dame</i>	Fall 2024
	Donald White Teaching Excellence Award (\$700) <i>Boston College</i>	Spring 2024
	Ivan Brown Research Grant (\$2,500) <i>Boston College</i>	Spring 2023
	Graduate Fellow at Clough Center for Democracy (\$5,000) <i>Boston College</i>	Fall 2022
	John B. Williamson Award (\$500) <i>Boston College</i>	Fall 2019
	Sociology Department Summer Research Fellowship (\$5,000) Summer 2020 & 2021 <i>Boston College</i>	
Conference Presentations	“Drilling and Dissent: Mapping Oil Governance, Corruption, and Contention as a Strategic Action Field” <i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>	Aug 2025, Chicago
	“Campus Co-opted: Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocratic Regimes” <i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>	Aug 2025, Chicago
	“Compliance on Campus: Universities and Pro-government Mobilization in Autocracies” <i>American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>	Sep 2024, Philadelphia
	“Performative Representation: Gender, Regime Type, and Ministerial Appointments” <i>American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>	Sep 2024, Philadelphia
	“Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)” <i>American Sociological Association (ASA)</i>	Aug 2023, Philadelphia
	“Sanctuaries or Battlegrounds? State Penetration in Places of Worship, University Campuses, and State Bureaucracy for Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran (2015–2019)” <i>Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM)</i>	Aug 2023, Philadelphia
	“The Organizational Infrastructure of Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran 2015-2019” <i>TextXD</i>	Dec 2022, California
	“The Organizational Infrastructure of Pro-Government Mobilization: Evidence from Iran 2015-2019” <i>Social Science History Association (SSHA)</i>	Nov 2022, Chicago

Research Experience	Research Assistant Fall 2023 <i>Older Adult Social Participation, Gender, and Cognitive Decline Project</i> PI: Dr. Eric M. Vogelsang, California State University, San Bernardino Funded by National Institutes of Health (NIH) Support for Research Excellence (SuRE) Program (R16)
Languages	<i>Coding:</i> R, Python, Stata, ArcGIS, L ^A T _E X <i>Languages:</i> Farsi (Native), English (Advanced), Arabic (Intermediate), Turkish (Beginner)
Teaching Experience	Boston College <i>Instructor</i> Introduction to Sociology Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2024 Student Evaluations: 4.6/5.0 (N = 113) - Created and taught an engaging and comprehensive course focused on foundational sociological concepts. This course gave students a strong foundation in key theories and principles and guided them in applying sociological analysis to critically examine contemporary real-world issues in the US and global societies. Introduction to Statistics Summer 2025, Summer 2026 Student Evaluations: 3.8/5.0 (N = 25) - Developed and delivered an intensive 6-week online asynchronous course that immersed students in fundamental statistical concepts. This course emphasized hands-on learning and equipped students with proficiency in Stata statistical software, helping them to manipulate, analyze, and visualize data effectively. Through engaging content and practical exercises, participants gained a deeper understanding of statistical methodologies and their real-world applications. <i>Teaching Assistant</i> Introduction to Statistics Fall 2019, Fall 2021, Spring 2021 Introductory Sociology for Healthcare Professions Spring 2020
Academic Service	Referee <i>American Journal of Sociology</i> <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> <i>Conflict Management and Peace Science</i> <i>ILR Review</i> <i>Digest of Middle East Studies</i> <i>Research on Aging</i>
References	Mohammad Ali Kadivar Department of Sociology Boston College kadivarm@bc.edu Wen Fan Department of Sociology Boston College wen.fan@bc.edu Yi Ming Department of Earth and Environmental Sciences Boston College yi.ming@bc.edu Paasha Mahdavi Department of Political Science University of California, Santa Barbara paasha@polsci.ucsb.edu Sara Moorman Department of Sociology Boston College sara.moorman@bc.edu Gerald M. Easter Department of Political Science Boston College gerald.easter@bc.edu